

Another notable factor was the appearance of Microsoft on the scene with their operating system—the PC-DOS Version 1.0—and the processor which was the first from Intel for IBM.

The adverse side-effect of this was that other no-name companies could obtain these same components and create their own version of the PC, and deplete IBM's market. But there was one aspect of the PC which could not be legally copied—the BIOS, as it was copyrighted and protected by law. However, Compaq and the others eventually found a legal but 'dishonest' way to duplicated that as well, opening the floodgates to cheaper (but still compatible) IBM clones.

Although not necessarily the best machine by technological standards, IBM's expertise and the fact that the IBM PC actually looked and felt like a professional computer system made it and numerous other PC clones extremely popular. They have evolved into today's Windows and Intel (Wintel) systems.

However, there was no mention of the term 'graphics card' either by chip or by name. This is because the entire graphics business had yet to take off. Nobody had yet tapped into the potential of the PC, and gaming on the PC was still a distant possibility.

As computer costs declined, the machines became more and

IBM Personal Computer	
Model	5150
Price	US \$3,000 (Rs 30,000)
CPU	Intel 8088 @ 4.77MHz
RAM	16K; 640K max
Display	80 x 24 text
Storage	optional 160 KB 5.25-inch disk drives
Ports	Cassette and Keyboard only Internal expansion slots
OS	IBM PC-DOS Version 1.0